



Step-by-Step: From one type to another

This reading provides you with the steps the instructor performs in the following video, [From one type to another](#). Watch as the instructor demonstrates how to format numbers and convert units of measurement in your spreadsheets.

Keep this step-by-step guide open as you watch the video. It can serve as a helpful reference tool if you need additional context or clarification while following the video steps. This is not a graded activity, but you can complete these steps to practice the skills demonstrated in the video.

What you'll need

If you'd like to access the spreadsheets the instructor uses in this video, click the links to the dataset to create a copy. If you don't have a Google account, you may download the data directly from the attachments below.

Link to movie data starter project: [Movie data starter project](#).

Link to weather table - data for convert: [Weather Table - Data for CONVERT](#).

OR

Example 1: Check and change data type

Check your data for inconsistent units of measurement to prevent problems during data analysis.

1. Open the [Movie Data Starter Project](#) spreadsheet using the link in the video.
2. Select Column M [Budget (\$)] and Column N [Box Office Revenue (\$)].
3. From the menu, select \$, the currency shortcut key.
4. Notice that the currency in Columns M and N are now formatted correctly.

Example 2: Convert temperatures from Fahrenheit to Celsius

Use the `CONVERT` function to change units of measurement.

1. Open the [Weather Table - Data for CONVERT](#) spreadsheet using the link in the video.
2. Select cell F2 and begin typing the Convert function formula as `=CONVERT`.
3. Indicate the cell you want to convert. After `=CONVERT`, enter `(B2 ,`.
4. Indicate the conversion you'd like to make: from Fahrenheit to Celsius. Enter `"F" , "C")`.
5. The formula in its entirety should look like this: `=CONVERT (B2 , "F" , "C")`.
6. Cell F2 now contains the temperature from cell B2 in Celsius.
7. Calculate temperature in Celsius for the rest of the column. Hover over cell F2 and select the fill handle, a small circle on a corner of the cell. Drag the fill handle to cell F193 to convert the other cells in the column to Celsius.

Note: Would you like more practice? Try converting the wind speed in Column D from miles per hour (mph) to meters per second (m/s) using `CONVERT`. In cell H2, enter:

`=CONVERT (D2 , "mph" , "m/s")`.

You can check if your conversion is correct by entering 8.5248 in a metric conversion tool, metric-conversions.org/speed/miles-per-hour-to-meters-per-second.htm.

Example 3: Lock data in a table

Using functions to convert data can lead to problems, which data professionals must be prepared to fix. For example, if a reference value changes, the calculated value also changes. Locking data in a table by changing it from a function to a value ensures a cell stays consistent even if the data around it changes.

1. Select cell F2. In the formula bar, notice that the contents of this cell are the function you entered in the previous example.
2. Right-click cell F and select Copy from the drop-down menu.
3. Right-click cell G and select Paste special from the drop-down menu. Then, select Paste values only. This option pastes only the values from the original selection, removing any formatting, functions, or other information.
4. Select cell G2.
5. In the formula bar, notice that the contents of this cell is a value. This means that the value won't change when other cells change.